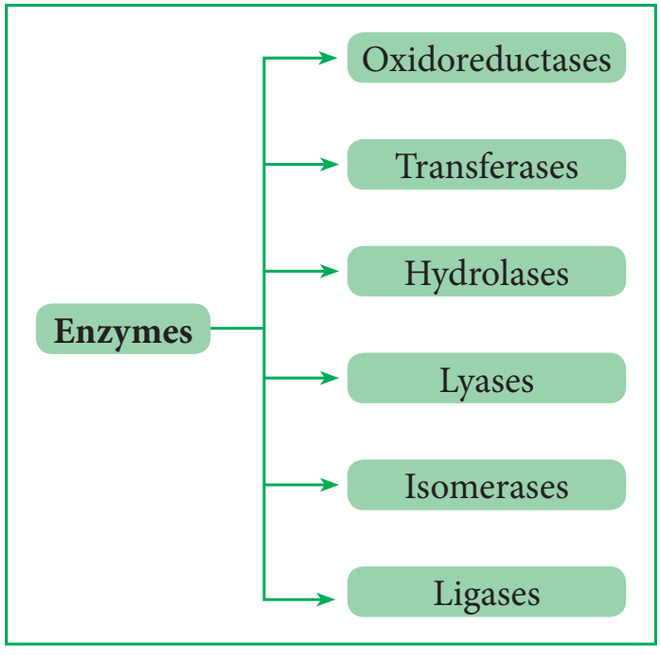
- The second part, ending in *–ase*, indicates the type of reaction catalysed.

Each enzyme is assigned a four-digit code number called Enzyme Commission (EC) number.

- The first digit represents the major class to which the enzyme belongs.
- The second digit denotes the subclass.
- The third digit denotes the sub-sub class of the enzyme within the major class.
- The fourth digit represents the serial number of the enzyme within the sub-sub class.

Example: Hexokinase (EC 2.7.1.1) and Glutamine synthetase (EC 6.3.1.2)

According to International Union of Biochemistry and Molecular Biology, the enzymes are classified into six major classes on the basis of the reaction they catalyse. The six major classes of enzymes are,



1) Oxidoreductases:

These are enzymes which catalyze the oxidation – reduction reactions between two substrates.

Examples: a) Dehydrogenase (Alcohol Dehydrogenase)

b) Oxidase (Cytochrome Oxidase)

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